

of special importance is the way things used to be
 to the man who once had nothing at all
 and now once every so often wishes he could return home
 i wish the twilight on the golf course had not been paved over

the concept of home troubles my elderly father
 who has lived everywhere but where he would most like to return
 big sky country for a big sky heart
 and i want nothing more than to welcome him into my heart
 and say you're home with us always dear dad
 it would only be fitting as the very first thing he did was welcome
 me into his life when i was born

"danny, this is your daddy speaking,"
 he heard his father's voice say

once upon a time we had a lake mcdonald cabin in the family
 a dream once embraced as the gathering point
 of a 'dyer' family named after those who die clothes
 going glacier to avalanche the ptarmigan sun road
 two medicine bozeman with the garden center across the road
 and feeling home with plenty in the hearts of the clan alive

In the dimming twilight of the room, where shadows dance softly on the walls, their embrace on the futon couch is a tender testament to the precipice upon which they stand – poised between the profound depths of friendship and the uncharted waters of something more.

Their closeness in the quiet room is a dance of paradoxes – a yearning so potent it resonates in their very bones, yet tempered by a mutual respect that sanctifies the boundary they have not crossed. Each touch, each glance, is heavy with a loving desperation, a silent plea whispered in the space between their heartbeats.

The air around them is thick with unspoken words, a lexicon of longing and restraint. His fingers graze her skin in a touch that is both a caress and a farewell, a lingering journey over the landscape of her arm that speaks more of reverence than of mere desire. Her response is a shiver, a delicate quake that travels through her body and into his, a symphony of silent confessions.

Their eyes lock, and in that gaze, there's a universe of unfulfilled wishes and unspoken promises. It's a look that holds the weight of every moment they've shared, every laugh, every tear, every profound conversation that has brought them to this precipice. In the depths of their eyes, there's a love so deep, so pure, it transcends the physical, dwelling instead in the realm of the soul. The moment their lips meet is a collision of stars, a kiss that is a convergence of all the love, the longing, and the unyielding respect they hold for one another. It's a kiss charged with the electricity of what could be, yet softened by the understanding of what is. The kiss is a question they are both afraid to ask and a reply they are not ready to hear, filled with a sweetness tinged with melancholy. They are explorers at the edge of a vast ocean, yearning to dive into its depths yet mindful of the tides that might sweep them away. In their embrace, there is a gentle urgency, a need to savor this moment of proximity that is both everything and not enough. As they lie there, wrapped in each other's arms, the room seems to breathe with them – a sanctuary for their love that is both passionate and chaste, desperate and content. The forgotten glasses of wine on the windowsill bear witness to this delicate balance – a symbol of their choice to savor the wine of their friendship without uncorking the headier bottle of romantic entanglement. In this cozy room, they find a haven where their emotions can whisper truths too profound for words. Here, they honor each other not just as friends but as souls who have touched the very essence of love – ineffable, innocent, and beautifully incomplete.

3

I want to turn the world inside out make friends with the voles know what kind of tea they like feel
the magma rippling beneath the surface / exhume the bodies of atoms long since seen
I want to dance in outer space free to kick and lift my limbs in any direction I see fit / learn what a
lack of anything feels like and know my peace where nothing meets
I want to change planes of reality adapt freely to a new identity / since context seems to be
everything to who I used to be and who I am now
I want to pluck the tendrils of a black hole honeysuckle gobble down the frenetic angst let it all be
captured in invisible recognition, resolution compacted, interred beyond belief beyond meaning
I want to scare you with how much I am / leave chemtrails when I pee
I need to live and know what it is to be accepting of the mediocre so I can learn how I'll find my free
embellishment on what it is that simply matters / rather than what needs to
I dream about making love to all my friends with such feverish intensity that they forget how things
used to be singing cortexes like candlewicks uncurled the flame of delight moaning rhapsody
incarnate
I imagine one day my parents will die and I am wanting to give birth to them before they do: the
simple knowing the security the implication of OK the feeding of light that grows warm within and I
want them to love their new identities like they taught me to love mine

I am in such agony over what could someday be if we stopped for a second to realize how things are
and I realize that fixation is a tremendous catch-22
the new paralysis of modernity / is dreaming so longingly about what could be / that we forget to
live life in the now
and we become too numb too dumb too scared to live it as if we might fuck it all up and what was
necessary might never be
well I want to see

4

*we pull the kaleidoscope down from our eyes and imagine we are both speaking and feeling in
shared experience*

When I finally learned how to be,
I was thirty three: ageless, bold,
exuberant: ready to find existence
for another two-thirds of my life!

—and as I returned to my senses
I realized it had been in living life itself which prepared me: a trusting; a simple sunset,
enjoyed elegantly through a glass of wine,
with you on the balcony:

I peered a furtive glance into my heart:
yes, the youthful incandescence I once
felt—now, the ready and wise
blossoming of anew! A flavor
I had yet to know as taste

—and when I knew how to survive,
I was already a third dead;
open, haunted to my mist:
somber eyes at a new year's funeral;
"I don't want to get old," I thought;
not ready, not ready, not ready to be—

—and when I was fifty four I cried
at my son's college graduation and I knew how far I'd come was more or less everything who I was

unfurled into existence, in its time;

I knew at forty-two that living was
for the ages: that experiences are
never more than we can handle,
except when we know we aren't true;

—and when I learned not to worry
was when I loved myself true,
and when I learned to live
it was not because of life, but because of how I had lived:

it was me: I was ready, finally; ready
to say 'no' to careless, ready
to say 'no' to fears, ready
to say 'no' to the outside, the not-me
as if it was never not near—

I learned to open myself from within,
trust my experience as clear,
knew when I had to heal, and
when I had to kneel,
to ask for forgiveness:

all the questions for someone else—
all the necessary, myself—
all the transgressions mine own—
all the redemption (strangely) within—

you see, I didn't need
to hear what I already knew—
but it was nice to be vulnerable
enough to recognize the answer
I had always had—

—and all the memories I create with you
are images of considerate bliss;
incandescent, even in a cold room:

glowing presence of this radiant sphere

(tumultuously spinning, tumbling, ever clearly off its angle, once again
churlish: taken by the current,
abject smear of token culprit:
saying, I know it's you who
I need to let back in:

all of you; myself)
when I come forth, come open,
come to realize what I always knew

that even with my anxieties and imperfections:
even as a crescent moon, seemingly dying—
actually living, ever turning; through stages
we know how purple moves to pink—
sometimes, in the sunset, how we give ourselves
permission to see it: permission to be it—

—and god when I do let go into you,
o otherness aware, you reflect me: my inner: even uncertain, I am tethered; never broken.

when I went to church once I realized what
I loved was—there? togetherness, and— a mystery—
my faith not so much in God but maybe
ourselves: myself, and each Other

—and when I know the lyrics of the
song inside seem bright— when I
stop listening solely to the melody expecting
to hear what I hadn't before—

—and when I rise up like gentle moon over
young forest; all fire, then reborn—
I know that I live again to find out where
my next course will run for me

—and when I let myself be graceful

I am home — living, enjoying the weather,
all clear for once a year and maybe more—
I know that I'm bound to see another day
where sun will rise and I'll feel free
on a hillside somewhere in France

(or, quite frankly, wherever the peace reveals)
I'll feel a gentle tousle of wind in my hair
imagine a lover's embrace: it is my own:
and when I am free I'll survive

—and even when I'm not, I'll prepare,
careful to know that when I compare
it is for the nostalgia of journey
rather than the abject misery of not-having:
if I am missing a way to the new:
I don't want that: but no one ever does:
when I regret, it is out of desire to live some more:
you, myself: it is the I and the other
to which I refer

—and so when I orchestrate connection
it lives for a heart I seek and
I once knew: being reborn,
anew; ready, perhaps, to challenge another day:
soon I'll be thirty two

5

the absence of knowing exactly what to do grieves the young bird who is perched on the cusp of his nest - he knows exactly how well he could fly if indeed he leapt to his quick demise with sudden aplomb, before soaring upwards - ready to begin another scattershot of instantaneous decisions each with their own residual impact on a life he has not quite yet lived. he stands, interested; his memories of the first time he tried something new floating contemplatively in his little birdbrain try as he might to give perfection to their midst he laughs with his eyes in their peception his visage flits downwards in reflection he gives a second thought to what has passed he locks eyes with that which is below
he is more than the single feather; he has many with which ideas and crescendo of flight beams

aloud, possible, certain, incontrovertible; introspection is the final bliss before the weather where the final approach is to find the gust that makes it clever to drop in and find out what really was meant to be: he'll see the hoot of the owl and the redness underwing the yellow of his warble on treble; the youngness is just beginning. and he is soon ready to go—

6

an okay but not great poem

if it is real i will always support you. i know the particulars of how sky becomes blue but could not demonstrate it for you so thank goodness we share that perception.
last weekend was when i cried at a sunset. last weekend was when i needed love and when i got just enough of it to pacify me. it was also then: i admitted i'd always love her.
the ACCORD decal on my dinged-up 2003 Honda
Accord fell off and just today i realized that maybe that was a predilection of sorts: i am not ready for someone in power of us who takes their power and uses it in feckless vain masking fearfulness with irresponsibility and lies fucking over someone just because you can and will
i have worked maybe about a week's worth over the past month at my job and i am not proud of that in fact it makes me feel terrible
i am dreaming big about my life and needing to move forwards / but i am still scared sometimes / and i do not have a resolution yet (to this poem or to life either for that matter)
i am doing wonderfully but i am still whining hurtling churning crashing into things trying to find my way through this life (man it's weird and beautiful and crazy and god i am here
i am still here

7

find me at the intersection of
grief and a reckoning
that elements may not be split
into particles beyond their matter
that life itself is a twisting
and a knowing of self within
and without – complete surrender
and trying one's very hardest
or best – sawdust at the mill –
smooth sandings and boat landings

of belief – home again,
what a relief, but is it?
there's a reason I don't like
to say goodbye, and that the
interminable space between
here and now seems so scary
because life is full of composure
in the face of lack of closure
and it beckons me to stay within:
good endings aren't really endings
they're just ways of being sure
that what you're over is like
a bird flying over – yes, it's gone
but does it really cease to exist
or can we just permit it
to find residency outside of our whole
we keep going in peace to pieces
and then back to our nest, even
if we must make our own
when I leave, I don't really leave
but when I am alone,
I am together by myself
in all my glory and inconsistency
there is power in being bold enough
to hold your own even
in great awe of what could be
kept truthful by what is
and when I let go I find peace
intransigent hue like
rhododendron petal in crisp
4 am bliss, all closed
in and crying – all
breathing and trying
as we live to see another day

it was like a sunset and a sunrise, on opposite ends of the world at the same time, when i finally

began to let go of my burning desire to take care of the world around me. i had been internalizing; and everything, every little moment, meant something to me, especially from those that i loved. i would care for the world over if it meant i could feel at peace in my own mind.

how i wanted to keep them all neat and at peace; how i wanted to refract their experience, to nourish their souls; how i wanted them to love me; how i wanted them to understand that i was alighted by their presence.

how i wished i could tell them i would only try to make their experience better, so that they could then do the same with mine. how that agreeable altruism would transcend us both - if only i could inspire it in them first. i still want desperately to entrust that in another again.

it was on a train, and i was thinking too deeply about a girl i loved; a friend was sitting next to me. she was on her own journey, and i was on mine; and in my mind, we were on one together. when i first realized i could unclutch my hands from my heart, i knew with gladness it was not necessary for me to let her go from me entirely.

that's what i had been afraid of. i had been scared that a letting-go necessarily meant a forgetting. and yet, she was still my friend; my respect for her only grew as i remembered who she was without me. her actions and presence became clarified - a reflection of her own experiences in life - rather than a statement of value upon me. i felt selfish.

i longed for absolution, but i knew i had to reconcile my own heart before seeking peace in another's.

so when i first began to love again, i felt scared.

i sat outside in the sunlight and let it bathe my skin; i cried, and i didn't know why i cried, so i meditated. i sat there, with my two cats watching me curiously, sitting in the grass with me; i breathed in and out; and i knew that loving again was not a coincidence of time and fate. it was a choice; and love would develop in the time that i gave to it; and so i cried some more, but perhaps differently this time.

when i was finished, i opened my eyes. my cats came over to check up on me. it does not matter whether they knew the same as me. but they did.

i do not know why it is that animals can feel so tenderly without resolve to do so, and yet have such a difficult experience communicating their process in doing so. i think it is the godself inside of us (that lives and loves) like another we encounter again and again throughout our lives, in different forms; and we mirror that happening as we encounter it: our volitions are our refracted humanity; it is the sun in the horizon making the sea green. it is humility, with charisma, with peace, with acceptance, with tenderness, when we love again.

we first must learn how to treat the otherness within ourselves right.

i want to live out in the middle of nowhere where the air will dry me after a shower / relaxing out in

the fresh open canvas of life / of sideways mental ordering where we are not propelled vertically or towards our destination with a virtual arrow always / no i want that arrow to surround me, as a halo around my stomach that will slowly rise and pull upwards as my life finishes / perhaps it will steal away one night under a million billion little stars and some young planet will get its wings its rings its defining moment its defining matter / my life will never be a waste because i say it to be so / i desire an everliving breath in a moment / i am still alive / sacrilege means nothing to a dandelion crooking its neck in the breeze / a gentle thought set in stone like a sculpture

10

the ambivalence of yellow, a finesse
of young spirit; surety while not
being sure; a jostle, a reminder
to oneself that we are still on
track to a someday on the other
side of the horizon. and clear
as it comes it goes it comes it goes
and onward is the word.
the peace of red. the intense
parity of independence; a scope
of which is still not known:
rhythm of cadence of breaking a stasis
and the newness of begin – had I forgotten
what it means to be alive sometimes?
letting go of hands once held so that
palms may face the sun wide open
and cheeks can warm and skin
can flush in the green
and the sky blue sky knows all
because it is nothing if it is not clear
with itself – even the pallid clouds
do not suffer in its expectation
(a declarative fuchsia)
a crescendo clearing the mist
a recognition therewith

11

(only write from the now
right about now lest
you leave behind a part of
yourself in a place you cannot see)
inveterate being, you are young
in your ways, though you fail
to remember your impermanence
of days; funny, how you yawn
at formerly-resolved fears as if
the ones you marvel creatively at
today cannot simply be solved by
letting them pass into narrow
designs or fruitless arrears—
when you ride the delicacy of
a moment like it is too fine to
really do anything (like be yourself
inside of it) you lose the great melancholy
of your ambivalence, don't you; your
two-way forest becomes a
topological minefield of distress
and malnourished anxieties
the languor of trying to unearth every
manure-piece, oxygenate in faith that
one day your flowers will bloom in the
quintessence of selection // adenosine
triphosphate // a sparkle of calculation
that the equation has no solution as
the variables continue to churn // when
there is a lovely elegance in the way that
it all works out sometimes isn't there?
we live to forget the middle
ground of things quickly forgiven
and the best thing to do is to
unceremoniously and peacefully
give it a first try so a second
glance seems smart because it all works out
doesn't it
the endurance of a spirit that wants to be

fair to itself – what we won't do
to try for something, someone,
when we really want it. we don't
need to try in order to receive it.
do not doubt your charisma;
it is bright and charming
like an opal: and those who see
the light coming from the inside
of it will give it a polished
consideration: and the waves of stars
inside will capitulate for another
when they do + they do + they do ———-

12

when we split our miracles into two
the clouds infer brightness
like blue learns yellow on its way to green
or a gas pump clicks a misty fullness:
we love life in absences;
the sonder of compulsion as a barn
protruding a bounty, unused;
when people come into new views
the acid burns a sepia hole in awareness;
when we love again, we dig
deeper on the treasure map than before,
freeing ourselves both from the box
where visiting hours bookend the characters
of the book that doesn't need to be written
to accompany the story of the teardrop
that falls implacably; two people to whom
sadness exists always and in connection
a melancholy lump of trust and forgiveness
and beginning again; even leaving,
beginning again,
even older, beginning again; even crying,
beginning again; always trying,
beginning again, the salt of kindness,

of "look at that bird on the windowsill,"
just to see the rouge on its belly
for a fleeting second it perches still
flit flutter of wing to digress onwards
about its day: and yet we saw it because
you saw it and you shared it to me
because you care what i think
and you care what i do
and you care that i'm there for you
a cozy around a tea kettle in a dark room
i don't care that it's 3am
and i'm writing love poetry to nobody
in particular– just because it exists
and yet i'd be amiss if i said
it wasn't meant to mean something
to everybody i've ever loved (and ever
could love) and i think i'll always
love them, love all of you
warble of a train passing along
an oceanside dipped in fog
and entrenched in abandon and ambition
so muffled you can nearly not hear the
vocalisms of stay clear i'm on the rails
mustn't go off the rails mustn't i? yes
concave essence with side-edges reaching
a light shining from amidst
a grove of trees that clear the way
as you pass through and nightdancers
can hear you scream; a well
of omission and portent to fill
to the stifling with the mulch
and milk of delicate sea, scrambling
to be felt as gentle as islands amidst it

it's not easy, is it? being intimate by yourself–
letting go of the stigma of knowing there are other

things in the world with which you might otherwise
occupy your time, for success of fulfillment or not.
when i was with you, Kristen, i tasted my comfort
in the love of another – you knew me – that’s why
we kissed, isn’t it – closed doors and open palms
on open palms, feet like foxes in a winter’s sleep
kisses like humanity’s celebration all in one
pursing of the lips & inside, all the things
we had yet to say – i do this all the time –
i never knew another – are you like myself –
I see myself inside of your silences:
I take all the lyrics I hear in the songs whose
melodies I had finally started to listen to again–
(a respite from all the words I hadn’t said
to another citizen; one in your earth:
you knew this maybe better than i did)
–and maybe that’s why I have words
to cause myself pain again, because I search
for elucidation in your looking-glass and all my
favorite songs are about you and they are
not about you – I teach myself to live
my life, now, Kristen: the person I wanted
to be, with you, for you; not needing, but giving–
I still need a lot these days–

14

i’m finally done with trying to fall in love to replace you. i’ve worked it out to a system of preset behaviors that i find myself doing regularly – and ones that i used to do – trying to love as deeply as i once did. the plateau-seeking enthusiastic bliss-mongering behavior routines no longer wreak havoc on my life as they once did. compulsive thinking towards my compassion has always plagued me, but pursuing idealism as a real concept within a relationship only brought the sword out of its hilt, and i’ve been slashing at the underbrush ever since, trying to see the light again as i once did. i’ve realized something. my absolutism to love like a naturalized deity has brought me to my knees. hubris has never been a thing i am afraid of, since i don’t believe so strongly in the absolute as to be afraid of it. but when i stopped living as to be most beneficent to myself, i prostrated myself on what i imagined to be the source of sunlight in the world, pursuing it as it crept away remorsefully, peacefully, to glow itself another day.

what i do know is that my impetus to reach for the cosmos has to be candid. it has to be unafraid. it has to not call any names as it reaches its arms out towards the things that it loves. it has to endure great constancy of emotion in trying to conjure up the might inside to keep the bulb alive and going. it is a flower pattern contoured to the bridle of returned oblivion. it finds its passion in the arcane mystery of unspoken success; it is early adrenaline coursing tightly across the splendid horizon. i am a new person since i loved you. i was new, then; i'm new, now. i will make no apologies for the fact that i didn't give up for so long. i did that because i felt it, and so i don't regret it. but i'm done looking at the past trying to define my future. my will to be alive goes a mile high and i keep my eyes open even in the wind. so when i finally forgive myself, i live to be through and through, free in my new being. and i'm almost there. i just need to say goodbye.

15

I dare you to kiss me. I dare you to know me for who I am, from my blissful past loves, to all the poetic fragments I can remember for you;
I want you to wonder what it is I am afraid about when I think about dying;
I want you to be the ant crawling on my body from the grass, unafraid that sometimes I'll want to flick you off;
I want you to see through my clouds and see them all at once;
I want you to pour maple syrup and seasonings into a bag and tenderize me and I want you to put me through the flames, I need you to saw into me; I am ready for you to trick me, to kill me, to trestle yourself between my natures;
listen, I don't mind if my rocks get chipped in the process: I've had enough scars on my body to know that it doesn't hurt to get used to something new;
I need you to bite my neck, I want to lose sight of what emblems I wear on my pretenses to hide my insecurities; I want you to adopt my pets like they were your own; I crave that you'll know what my favorite songs are and hum them before you put them on, as you put them on; I loathe you, I am so in love with you and the future of what could have been and might still be;
you're a rock I hold in my mouth and learn to speak around; you're a tree I gesture to as it obscures the light; you're an ample metaphor in a deserving paragraph of my writing; you are a premonition of daggers and leaves as they shoot through the firmament intending nothing but landing somewhere on another side; you could be invited to every single party, you could be a matron of the world in so many different ways;
if you were any more unreal you'd be the very reason strings would swell through the interpolation of their semitones; god, I think you just might be the harmonic vibrations too;
run a marathon with me another night;
let me almost never get a chance to say thank you, for how fast we are moving and all that we are doing;

I envision getting lost with you would create more than it would eviscerate;
I want you to tell me to go away when I get too close; I want you to give me the signal that reminds me five thoughts beneath the surface that I am doing fine; I want to take care of myself like I know you're taking care of you; I want to need you like a wet dream, all fascination, torpor of desire, rolling hills and a house somewhere in between on the fourteenth as I turn right, and the inside is not required to be entered from the outside since I am already there, and as we slide onto the couch our souls decry their everythings as they leap upwards, our legs are weightless, we hover and pull away from each other as we remain together, our sets of legs attracted like two polar opposites by some external lack of gravity: our gravity is here, in our embrace, in the soft light that is eyes closed, and our arms wrap, moving freely, telling the care that is acquired, keeping us together in the most unbridled adjacent state.

We low like creatures. nothing need be known for us to bray our message to the color of the world surrounding us: and you hear me, you are with me on my plane; and all the times I didn't feel right are all right and even when I won't feel all right when I'm with you, we know this may be always an ending before it is a beginning in life, but it is splendid to share this exuberance with you while we still have it. Grow misty-eyed at the thought of old people's reservations at the ballet with me. Endure the perception of everything in between as treasured while we look for the clearer moments when we know what to do. Declare the right to be alone with me and maybe only me for for a little while, like you want something from me. It is okay if you do not know what it is. The moth didn't know the light until it bumped into it. Please try to see yourself forever as a source of light in this world.

16

listen —

i moved across the country a few years ago
and i want to tell you about it
but not the part you think
not the boxes
not the new zip code
not the how's seattle treating you

i want to tell you
about the story i packed without meaning to
a little story called this is just how it is now
this is what moving does
this is what adulthood does

this is what being far away does

and that story

did more miles than the u-haul

did more damage than the distance did

because the distance was just

geography

the story was a whole religion

listen —

distance is real

but distance is not the king of anything

unless you crown it

unless you kneel

unless you write into heart

the physics that authorizes the vanishing

and i had been writing that physics for three years

and calling it realism

listen —

i went home last month

not home where the golf course got paved over

the place home before I knew the word home

the home where people still say my name

like they mean it

and my body — when I heard my name said like that

my body filed a report and the report said

oh. oh that's what left. not love.

current.

because love survives anything

love will sit in a drawer and wait for you

love is patient

love is a saint

but current —

current is tuesday
current is game night
current is 1:13 a.m.
current is look at this bird
current is the ongoing update of who you are in the people who know you

and i had been mistaking love preserved
for presence ongoing
and calling the difference adulthood

listen —
i am very good at taking care of people
i am very good at listening carefully
at tracking what might land
at shaping myself around what will work
and somewhere along the way i built a cathedral
without meaning to

a cathedral of care
so intricate
so considered
so acoustically beautiful
that my longing never had to arrive naked
never had to stand in the doorway
shivering
never had to say i want you to be near me

because the cathedral said it first and said it better
and said it in a register that could be mistaken for service

and the cathedral is real
the cathedral has saved me more than once
and also — i am tired of paying its full invoice
because the naked sentence is not hard

you matter to me
i miss you
i want to stay in the thread

three sentences a child could say
a child does say
without being asked

listen —
the courage now is not big
the courage now is the size of a text
the courage now is the size of a facetime
placed on a tuesday
without ceremony
without manuscript
without the careful architecture of preparation
the courage now is — hey. would you want this too?

and then the trembling
the trembling before the answer
the trembling that is the sound of the sentence leaving
the architecture
listen — maybe the adulthood i was handed was a lie

maybe i don't have to mature into not needing my people
maybe the mature thing is to say
i am still small enough to need you
i am still animal enough to want recurrence
i am still young enough to ask
without pretending i've outgrown the asking

so this is me at the microphone telling you —
i will not vanish to stay connected
i will not translate myself into a shape
that can be loved
without being known
i will not field-manage my way into ongoing absence

i am building rooms with windows that open regularly
i am staying weather to the people i love
small weather

real weather

returning weather

and the wanting sentence will enter the room undressed and it will tremble

and it will tremble

and it will tremble and then —

it won't

listen—.